

on a tablet or a hybrid. For example, web browsing or watching videos. You could use a tablet without having to lug around a keyboard attached to it, or even use it comfortably in the car or lazily on the bed. Not all ultrabooks offer a touch-screen, but all tablets and hybrids offer that. And for most tasks, at least those that fall under the bracket of “content consumption”, the touch environment works better.

Unless you are at the very top of the food chain, where a BlackBerry phone for sending one line responses to emails is considered a fairly hectic day at work, chances are that you will actually be spending a lot of time with a PC. This could involve a fair amount of text heavy documents, presentations and spreadsheets and possibly even more. While a tablet or a hybrid may work well for some (depending on comfort level with a more compromising form factor), we would recommend a proper 13-inch or 15-inch screen size ultrabook or laptop for getting some actual work done. Since most of us go through cycles of consumption and creation during the same day, this one's a tie.

Score: Ultrabooks 2 - Tablets 2 - Hybrids 3

The OS

While Android remains the platform of choice in India for a consumption device, Windows 8 hybrids have brought a rather fresh perspective to the tablet ecosystem – in a space otherwise dominated by Android and iOS for the past two-three years. Through Windows 8, what you get is a full-fledged OS, which can be used to replicate almost all the tasks you



The best of both worlds

do on an ultrabook. With hybrids, you get the ability to run most PC apps on the go, whereas with ultrabooks you get complete satisfaction without compromise. with , with enhanced file compatibility. Result? A tie between ultrabooks and hybrids, where tablet OSes still have a lot to do to effectively challenge the might of Windows.

Score: Ultrabooks 3 - Tablets 2 - Hybrids 4

Price

The critical bit to most of us. Price is the great leveller of most debates involving purchasing decisions, as it should. You could be looking at some very decent tablets just upwards of ₹16,000, (Samsung Galaxy Nexus 7 tablets, etc). Spend a little more, and you get into the Apple iPad Mini and the Apple iPad/Samsung Galaxy Note 10.1 territory. Just below ₹30,000 is where the Windows

8 hybrids come into the picture. And just beyond ₹40,000 is where the first ultrabooks emerge. Hands down tablets win, as they are the most inexpensive of the three form factors.

Score: Ultrabooks 3 - Tablets 3 - Hybrids 4

Features

In this particular criteria, tablets and hybrids will always trail the ultrabooks of the worlds. Things such as screen size: will you be OK with a 7-inch tablet? What about 9- to 11.6-inch? If portability is of utmost importance, you might settle for a smaller screen, if not, you want as large a screen as possible without making it too heavy to carry easily. Ultrabooks seem to win hands down because of a more diverse feature set and the ability to choose from a wider range of screen sizes and weights.

Score: Ultrabooks 4 - Tablets 3 - Hybrids 4

Gaming

In the realm of mobile games, the activity of playing games on your devices is essentially of two types in this context: the casual Angry Birds/Despicable Me/Simpsons types or more serious FPS / MMORPG type that needs better and beefier hardware. The choice is almost made instantly between tablets and ultrabooks, based on the type of gamer you are. Android or iOS are equally awesome for casual gaming, and fully-functional Windows is still the choice for PC gaming. Hybrids, sadly, don't score a point here.

Score: Ultrabooks 5 - Tablets 4 - Hybrids 4



The iPad, the ultimate tablet?